

Phase_Preliminary

TOGAF ADM - Preliminary Phase

Purpose: Prepare the organization for TOGAF projects (ONE-TIME setup)

Overview

PRELIMINARY PHASE
PURPOSE: Set up the Enterprise Architecture CAPABILITY DONE: ONCE for the organization (not for every project) OUTCOME: EA team, tools, principles, governance ready to guide ALL future architecture projects

Key Activities

Define Architecture Capability (5 Pillars)

EA CAPABILITY (5 PILLARS)
1. CREATE TEAM (People) └ Enterprise Architects, Domain Architects, support staff 2. SETUP TOOLS └ Sparx EA, Archi, Confluence, Draw.io, GitHub 3. DEFINE PRINCIPLES └ Cloud-First, Security by Design, Buy over Build 4. ESTABLISH GOVERNANCE

└─ Architecture Board, Review process, Compliance

5. DEFINE STANDARDS

└─ Technology standards, Patterns, Reference architectures

All this happens in PRELIMINARY PHASE (once)

Then EA GUIDES all projects using these!

Architecture Principles

Principles are **guiding rules** that help make consistent decisions across ALL projects.

PRINCIPLES GUIDE EVERY PROJECT

PRELIMINARY: Define Principles (ONCE)

- Cloud-First
- Security by Design
- Buy over Build
- API-First
- Data is an Asset

↓
These GUIDE every project
▼

PROJECT 1: Payment System

Driver: "Reduce latency"

Decision: "Should we use on-prem or cloud?"

→ Check Principle: "Cloud-First" → Use Cloud ✓

PROJECT 2: CRM Selection

Driver: "Need better customer management"

Decision: "Should we build custom CRM or buy?"

→ Check Principle: "Buy over Build" → Buy Salesforce ✓

PROJECT 3: Mobile App

Driver: "Launch mobile experience"

Decision: "How to handle authentication?"

→ Check Principle: "Security by Design" → OAuth from start ✓

PRINCIPLES = Consistent decision-making across ALL projects

Principle Structure

Each principle has 4 parts:

Component	Description	Example
Name	Short identifier	"Cloud-First"
Statement	What it means	"All new applications should be deployed on cloud unless there's a valid reason not to"
Rationale	Why this principle	"Cloud provides scalability, cost efficiency, and modern capabilities"
Implications	What it means for decisions	"Teams must evaluate cloud options first; on-prem needs Architecture Board approval"

Architecture Principles vs Architecture Requirements (NFRs)

Architecture Principles	Architecture Requirements (NFRs)
Guiding philosophy	Specific metrics
"Systems should be resilient"	"99.99% uptime"
"Prefer cloud-first approach"	"Must use AWS/Azure"
"Design for performance"	"100ms latency"
"Systems should be loosely coupled"	"Use microservices with REST APIs"
WHY we design a certain way	WHAT we must achieve

Reference Architectures

Reference Architectures are **proven, reusable templates** for solving common architecture problems.

REFERENCE ARCHITECTURE

WHAT IT IS:

- A TEMPLATE / BLUEPRINT for a common solution
- Pre-approved, proven pattern
- Ready-to-use starting point
- Standardized across organization

EXAMPLES:

- Microservices Reference Architecture
- Data Lake Reference Architecture
- E-commerce Reference Architecture
- Cloud-Native Web App Reference Architecture

BENEFITS:

- ✓ SPEED → Don't design from scratch
- ✓ CONSISTENCY → All teams follow same patterns
- ✓ QUALITY → Proven, tested designs
- ✓ COMPLIANCE → Pre-approved by Architecture Board

Key Deliverables

Deliverable	Description
Organizational Model for EA	Team structure, roles, processes
Architecture Principles	Guiding rules for all decisions
Architecture Repository	Storage for all architecture assets
Architecture Governance Framework	How decisions are made and enforced
Tailored Architecture Framework	TOGAF customized for your organization

Common Misconception

✗ WRONG vs ✓ CORRECT UNDERSTANDING

✗ WRONG:

"Preliminary Phase is done for EVERY project"

✅ CORRECT:

"Preliminary Phase is done ONCE to set up the EA capability"

"Projects start from Phase A (Architecture Vision)"

PRELIMINARY (Year 1):

Setup: Team + Tools + Principles + Governance + Standards

(Done ONCE)



PROJECT 1 (uses EA):

Phase A → H
(Starts at A)

PROJECT 2 (uses EA):

Phase A → H
(Starts at A)

Summary

PRELIMINARY PHASE = SETUP THE "ARCHITECTURE KITCHEN"

- Create the EA team (chefs)
- Setup tools (equipment)
- Define principles (recipes & standards)
- Establish governance (quality control)
- Define standards (ingredients list)

Once the kitchen is ready, it serves ALL projects!